School Council Meeting Agenda

School: Silverheights Public School

Date & Time: January 12, 2022, 6:00-8:00 pm

Location: Virtual Google Meet

"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.
They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.
Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."

Ontario Ministry of Education

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome & Introduction** Introduction of new members Sign attendance sheet	15 mins	Chair (Ling Tam)
	Review & approval of agenda		
	Review & approval of previous meeting minutes - **Accepted by Alison & Helen**		
2	**Business Arising from the Minutes**	5 mins	Council Members
3	**Old Business / Updates**	5 mins	Council Members
4	**News**		
	WRAPSC - Link to monthly meeting minutes: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/minutes/ - This month's meeting topic is equity & inclusive: How do we promote equity & inclusion in our meetings? - Gr6/8 Celebrations – focus on community not consumerism. Keep celebrations in the school. - Explore Your Future events: Science guest speakers, Pathways to Post-Secondary institutions; workplace virtual tours - Guidance on dealing with hate-speech - Providing inclusive space for potentially racialized council members	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoh)
	PIC	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoah)
	Student Updates	5 mins	Student Rep
	Teacher Updates - Intramurals were running and going great, looking for what happens next - Spirit Days coming next, leaving before break was great to see student involvement - Online attendance in the intermediate division has been good but unable to assess other grades.	10 mins	Teacher Rep (Chad Moffat)

	- Awaiting new rules for return to in-person learning - Bell Let's Talk Day coming next week – look for communication in coming days. - Staff is engaged & ready to get back to in-person		
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - Check out the SNA social media feeds as there are weekly updates for upcoming winter programming.	10 mins	Community Rep (Lori Ryan-Da Cunha)
5	**Principal's Report** - COVID update: Board is meeting to provide further directions to schools. School admin meeting tomorrow with the board & announcements will be made. - New masks are on route (3-ply surgical masks for students if needed, & N-95 masks for educators). Students can continue to use their cloth masks. - HEPA air purifier units on route; School admin yet to determine how to deploy but not likely in every classroom. Currently, school has 8 units (4 Kindie classes, ACE class & 2 staff areas). - Procedures within the school being updated including (not limited to) daily screening, cohort transitions, community meetings etc. - Rotary for Music & Science continue. - Locker access has been more rigorously scheduled. - Staff shortages are managed based on absentee rates. Silverheights absentee rate of 4-6% (pre-COVID, below average compared to board average). Need to be >30% baseline (i.e. 35% absentee rate) before classes/schools are closed. - Remote Learning Options for Parents: o Teacher will keep their Google Classroom updated to support students who are REQUIRED to be at home (isolation). o If the families CHOOSE to keep their student at home, the board has provided resources (professionally curated resources) but is not teacher-led. Teacher cannot "hybrid" teach their classes in person and online. o Homeschool is alternative (though not preferred). o Switch to Remote School (Out of Boundary Request required) which is	10 mins	Principal (Jason Stere)

subject to the same class size limitations set by the Ministry.

- Technology Update (Carolina)
  - Tremendous effort from staff to get Chromebooks ready for deployment.
  - Deployment of Chromebooks in December under contract for accountability for technology.
  - Return of Chromebooks with child upon return to school will be reconciled via contracts assigned.
  - Moving forward, a bigger buffer in the technology allotment to have flexibility for Chromebooks to be available if classrooms have to shutdown/isolate. Currently Gr 7-8 have 1:1 ratio. The buffer will have to be created based on the existing technology in the school (i.e. reducing # units in Kindie, Primary & Intermediate classrooms).
- Is there clarification on testing/symptoms? Total of 10 symptoms on the School Screening Tool.
  - A PCR test kit will be sent home with students if they become symptomatic at school
  - RAT kits will be sent home with kids
  - Awaiting clarification for PCR vs Rapid Antigen Testing (RAT) from board based on recent Ministry announcement. Continue to use the Ontario Screening Tool: https://covid-19.ontario.ca/school-screening/?WRDSB_Schools_Button
- Resource requests from staff:
  - Pilot program for class set of headphone to support adaptive tech using Google Read/Write. Bulk Unit pricing of $10/15 per unit = ~$400. **Vote = Approved by Council**
  - Integrate mic in board-supplied Chromebook is poor quality. Requesting external mic for select teachers = ~$400. **Vote = Approved by Council**
  - Professional Development tools:
    - Junior team on Growth Mindset (3 books = ~$160). Sharing of highlights with Council would be a great feedback;

	▪ Book Study Set (related to trauma & children, inclusion, & brain development). Cost to be teachers & council & based on # participants (~$400) ○ Replace microphones for audio equipment in the gym. Quote already obtained from Long & McQuade (board-approved vendor). Capital cost = ~$3000 ○ ArtShine (https://www.artshine.ca/) is a non-profit art group that supports all forms of art. Known to run afterschool program & support families who cannot afford extracurricular activities. Asking ~$3000 to commission an interactive mural with emphasis on inclusivity for inside entrance to the school to replace trophies/plaques. Preliminary Idea is Turtle Island with interactive shell that can be updated annually by the students. Should be completed during the March Break when no students are in the building ○ STEM & Science Class Rockets = $350 ○ Outstanding: Gym Mural work not yet complete but budget had been accounted.		
	Equity Connections	5 mins	Vice-Principal (Carolina Miranda)
6	**Financial Report** **Balance = $10,630.52** *Wish List (as referenced in Principal's Report):* • Gymnasium Tech upgrade (mics, chargers, cords, bodypack, cords, accessories & install) = $3,500 (school request) • Microphones (one per class) = $1,000 (teacher request) • Headphones (pilot) = $1,000 (teacher request in consultation with Spec Ed) • Growth Mindset (professional resource) = $100 (teacher request) • Rockets (Science & STEM class) = $350 (teacher request) • Hallway Mural = $1,750 Council contribution + $1750 from school • Rockets (Science & STEM class) = $350 • Total Wish List = $ 8,100	10 min	Treasurer

	Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf PIC Grant All School Councils automatically receive $500 from the MOE for events or activities to "engage parents in their child's education." Funds must be spent between Sept. 1 & June 30. • Intent Form is required to be submitted (Jason Stere can complete this form); will be clawed back from school funds budget if we do not account for what we did with it. Ideas: Math night; Mental Health nights. PRO Grant These grants encourage parent engagement at the local, regional & provincial levels & are designed to support parents in identifying barriers to parent engagement in their own community & to find local solutions to involve more parents in support of student achievement & well-being. Link: https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSf2AWcqoRS1b5OOVXJm9tSzPHMmts1cvHqYv0f7OzPHYLAW5A/viewform Deadline for Application: January 14, 2022 • *DEFERRED - Topic for discussion back in September in order approach other schools to combine efforts. Suggestion for holding a joint Council meeting with potential school partner. Make priority to start building connections with local schools to make the connections this year.*		
7	**Fundraising Committee** • Most fundraising on hold with remote learning in place. Fundraising committee not yet in place. Let's get the financials in place and see where we are currently Goal-setting Ongoing fundraising initiatives (pizza days, smencils) Special Event initiatives (family movie nights)	10 mins	Subcommittee Rep:
8	**New Business**	30 min	Council Members
9	**Questions & Answer Period** - Erin wishes to inquire about Spiritwear; is this still happening?	10 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date (online):**	February 9, 2022	N/A
	Agenda Items for Next Meeting • Updated financial statement from Head Secretary • Meeting minutes to be sent to Council for voting next week (week of Jan 17).	5 mins	Council Members

	• Google Form to be sent to Council to vote on resource requests from staff		
11	**Adjournment**	20:10	N/A

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

Attendance Sheet				
	Role	**Name**	**Email**	**Phone**
1	Chair	Ling Tam	silverheightscouncil@gmail.com	519-546-3155
2	Secretary (Rotating)	Karen Petznick		
3	Principal	Jason Stere	jason_stere@wrdsb.ca	
4	Vice-Principal	Carolina Miranda	carolina_miranda@wrdsb.ca	
5	Teacher Rep	Chad Moffat	chad_moffat@wrdsb.ca	
6	WRAPSC / PIC Rep	Amy Pharoah	Yes	
7	Member at Large	Helen Parker-Brown		
8	Member at Large	Erin Ambachtsheer		
9	Member at Large	Alison Chong		
10	Member at Large	Jenn Latour		
11	Member at Large	Melissa Resendes	Melisaresendes@gmail.com	

Regret:

Treasure Kauppila

Lori Ryan-Da Cunha

WRAPSC Update January

- Bep.wr.ca
- Free & must sign up for Explore Your Future speaking events, Grade 7-12:
    - Jan. 19 Science https://www.bepwr.ca/blog/explore-your-future-careers-in-science
    - Feb. 9 Pathways to Post Secondary Institutions: Laurier, Waterloo, etc.
    - Feb. 23 Co-op
- Past Explore Your Future events: https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCh1D76qh45zmEDMJTu8E54w
- Waterloo Region Virtual Workplace Tours: https://www.bepwr.ca/virtual-tours

Indigenous, Sovereignty, Equity and Inclusion, Human Rights at WRDSB

- Board Improvement & Equity Plan in 5 areas; tracking and accountability using student census:
    - Human Rights & Equity
    - Mental Health, Well-Being and Engagement
    - Transitions & Pathways (university, college, etc.)
    - Learning Recovery & Renewal (early learning, mathematics, and re-engagement)

- Modules as a resource to improve equity in school councils will launch soon. February is the plan.
- Equity celebrates reduction in harm
- Students shouldn't feel like they have to hide a part of themselves.
- Fundraising: don't make yourself look as the saviours if donating to families in need
- https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/1017-Human-Rights.pdf
- hate speech document given to administrators given at the beginning of the school year
- Ways to Improve Equity in our School Councils: make sure you really give space to racialized people to speak at meetings; example given that they are raised to be silent. Asking them if that if it is okay for the chair to call on them sometimes, and if they feel comfortable for her to call on them for their thoughts; don't cut off racialized people. Gather their ideas outside of meetings and represent it in meetings, if they can't be there.
- Grade 8 celebrations:
    - Some parents' fears were that the board was erasing celebrations.
    - The board is not just tracking the majority of voices; they are listening to the minority's needs for equity
    - instead of consumerism, instead focus on community and celebration, and also putting funding in classrooms; previous celebrations put undue pressure on girls for clothes and financial

Mental Health:

School Mental Health Equity Team Lead: Mental Health resource: https://jack.org/covid

WRDSB Lunch and Learn Psychology series: Wednesdays 12:15-12:45

Topics:

- Parenting Your Child with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)
- Why Your Child Gets Stuck (And What to do About it)

https://www.wrdsb.ca/blog/2021/12/14/january-lunch-and-learn-sessions-for-parents-and-caregivers/

Indigenous Sovereignty, Equity & Inclusion and Human Rights at the WRDSB

WRAPSC Presentation

January 11, 2022

Territorial Acknowledgement

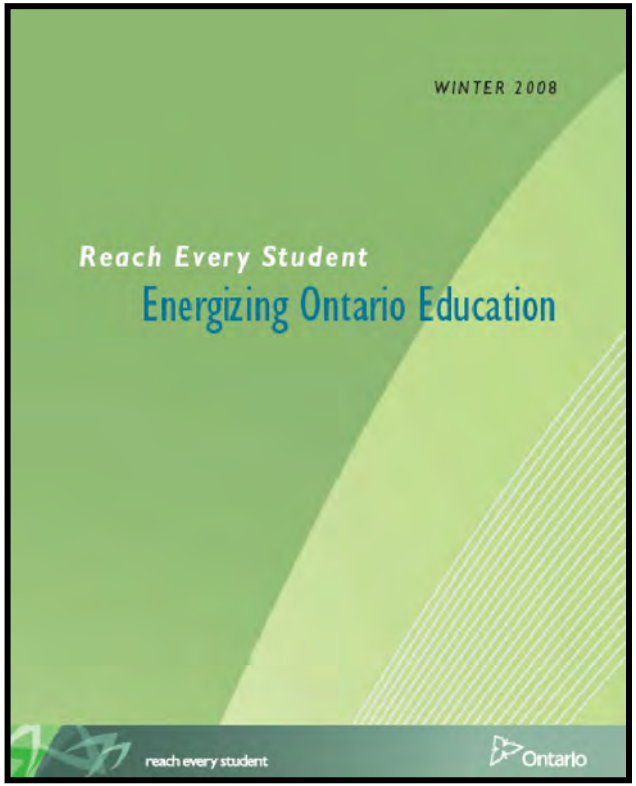
We acknowledge that the land on which WRDSB sites are situated are the lands traditionally used by the Haudenosaunee, Anishinaabe, and Chononton people. We also acknowledge the enduring presence and deep traditional knowledge, laws, and philosophies of the Indigenous people with whom we share this land today.

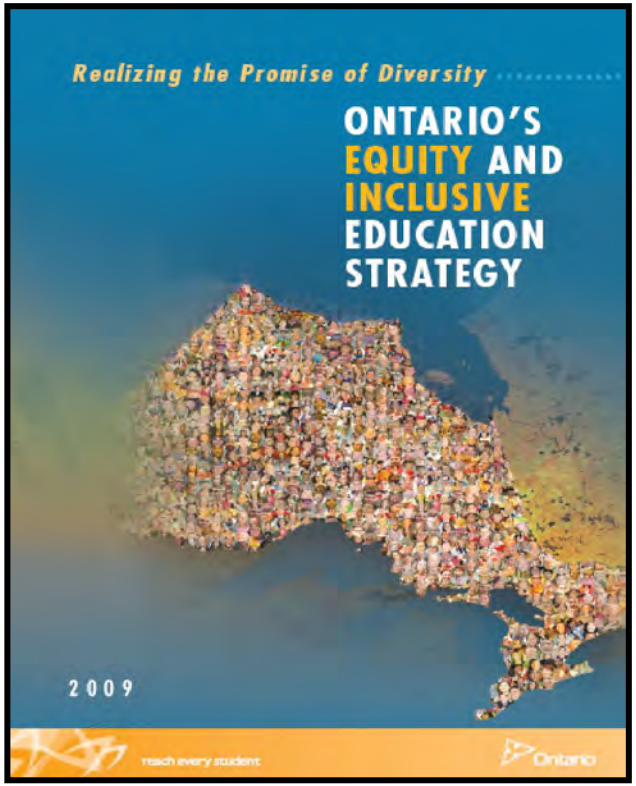


Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms
&
Ontario Human Rights Code

The Waterloo Region District School Board (WRDSB) is committed to meeting its obligation under the ***Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms*** and the ***Ontario Human Rights Code*** by providing inclusive, safe and caring schools and workplaces that respect the rights of every individual. Every student, employee, trustee, parent and community member has the right to learn, work and interact in an environment free of discrimination and harassment.

System Improvement
Equity of Access/Outcomes

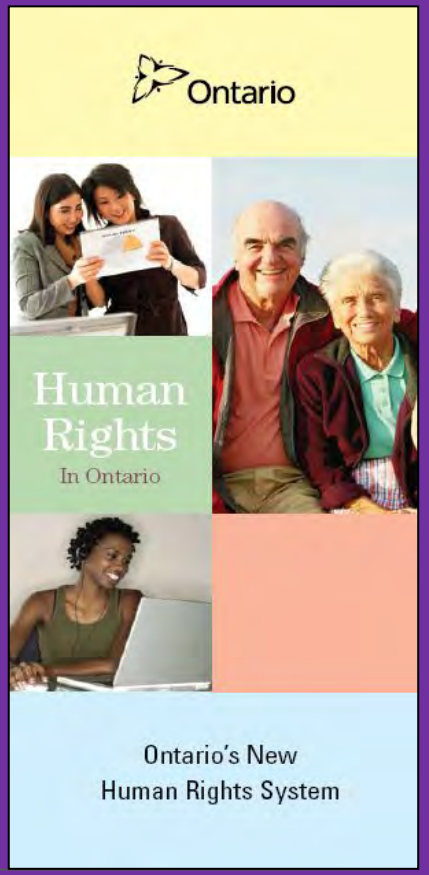




WATERLOO REGION DISTRICT SCHOOL BOARD

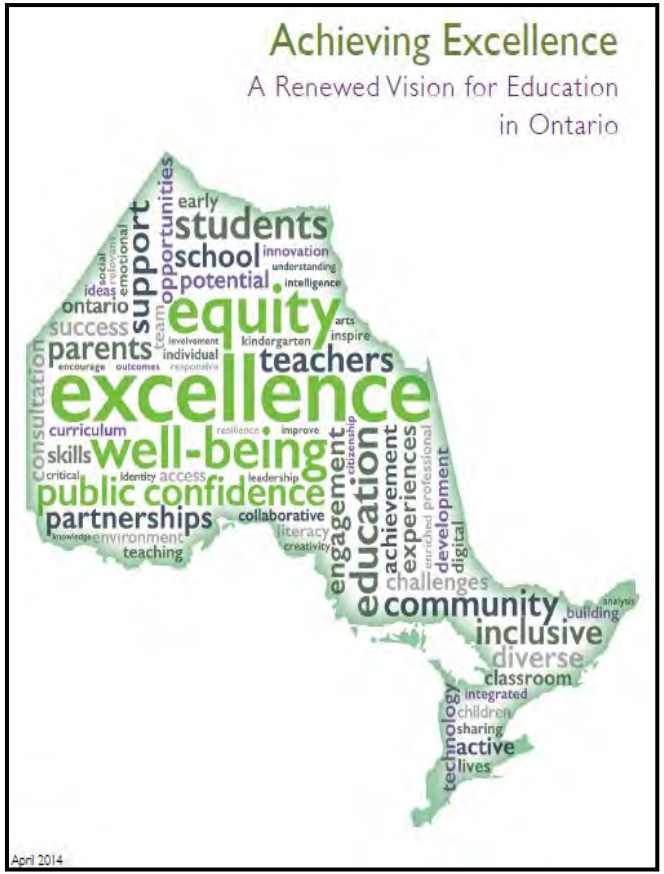
Addressing persistent barriers in education enables each person to fully and freely take part in society.

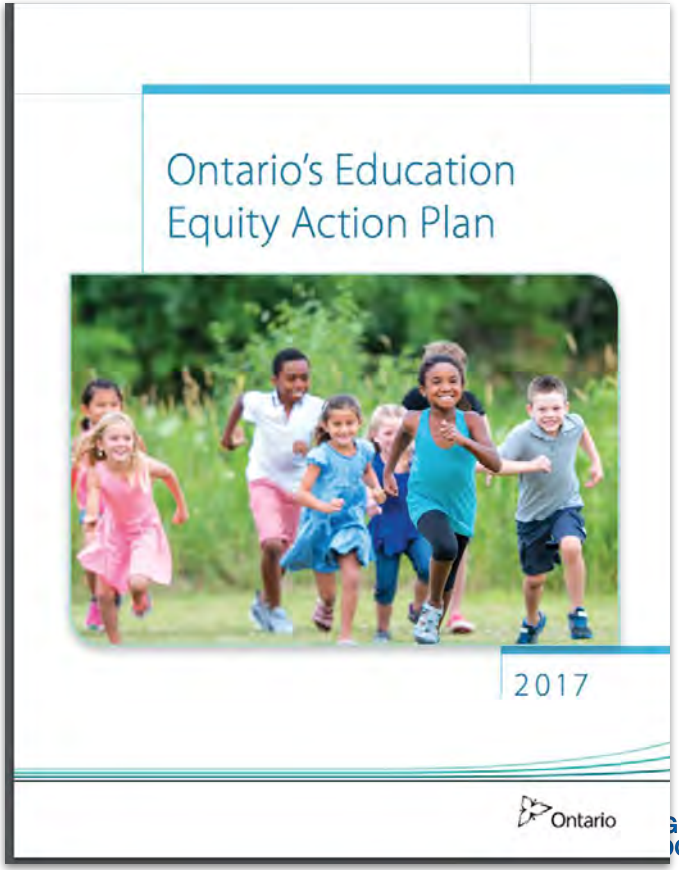
Strategic Direction: Promote and strengthen a human rights culture in Ontario that encompasses both human rights and responsibilities, with a special focus on educating children and youth and addressing systemic discrimination in our education system.



Education

System Improvement
Equity of Access/Outcomes





ONTARIO'S EQUITY ACTION PLAN 2017

Systemic barriers are caused by embedded biases in policies, practices and processes, and may result in differential treatment, and are often the result of doing things the way they have always been done.

Regardless of the reason for them or their intentions, their impact can be detrimental to many.

Equity Action Plan, 2017

Board Improvement and Equity Plan 2021

Along with the *Board Action Plan on Indigenous Education*, the BIEP increases accountability and standardizes commitments for advancing human rights and equity across the education system.

Board Improvement and Equity Plan (BIEP)

- **Sets out province wide goals and outcome measures in 5 priority areas:**


1) Achievement

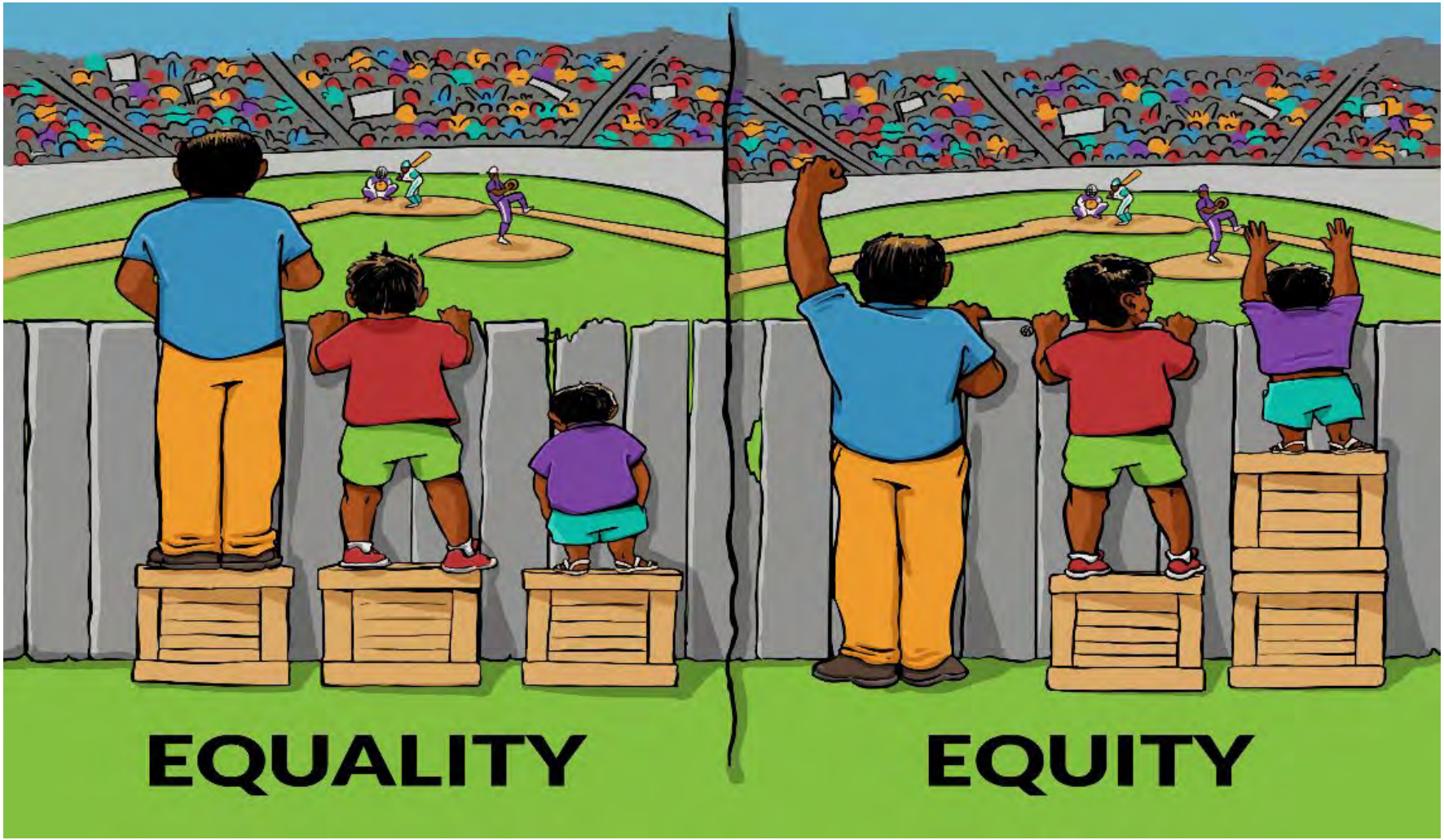

2) Human Rights and Equity

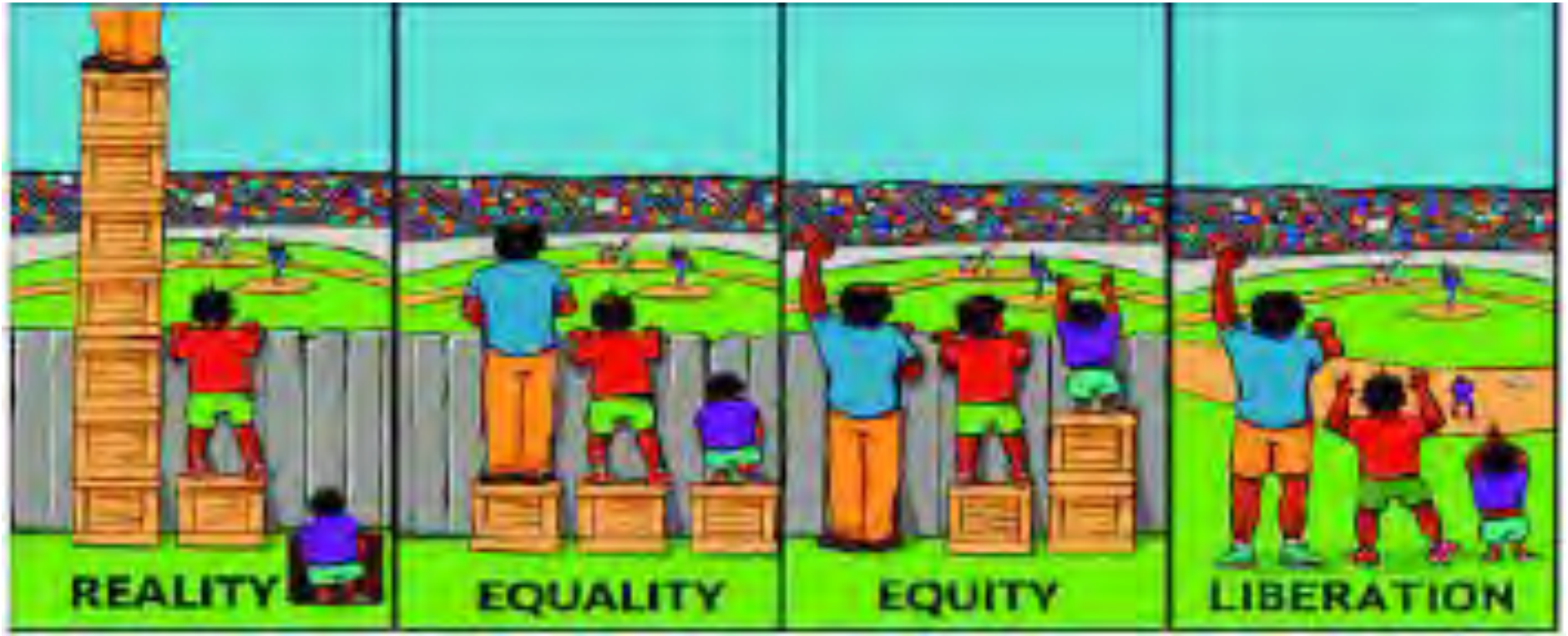

3) Mental Health, Well-Being and Engagement


4) Transitions and Pathways


5) Learning Recovery & Renewal

Transformational Change Needs to Occur To Ensure that Students' Identity No Longer Predicts Their Outcomes


EQUALITY
EQUITY


REALITY
EQUALITY
EQUITY
LIBERATION

EQUITY IS **NOT**:

- simple, immediate solutions
- neutrality
- changing students, culture, or behavior
- treating everyone the same
- embracing colour-blindness
- celebrating diversity (only)
- being nice and kind (only)
- focusing on INTENTIONS
- the easy way
- the status quo
- an add-on
- a fad
- an endpoint or place you arrive



EQUITY **IS**:

- Redistribution of resources
- purposeful attention to SYSTEMS of power: racism, sexism, classism, ableism, heterosexism
- a LENS: a way of seeing imbalances of POWER
- recognizing even subtle forms of bias, inequity, and discrimination
- responding to and redressing all forms of bias, inequity, and discrimination
- applicable to EVERY subject
- focus on fixing *systems*, not *kids*
- critical self-reflection; personal—not just at school/work
- maintaining high expectations for ALL students by considering factors and inequities outside of our control
- focus on IMPACT



Role of School Council in Creating Equitable Schools

- Disrupt our traditional views and expectations
  - Video resource being developed
- Understanding the difference between charity and equity
  - A parable
- Ask reflective questions to ensure equitable outcomes

School Council Membership and Meetings:

Diversity asks, “Who’s in the room?”

Equity responds: “Who is trying to get in the room but can’t? Whose presence in the room is under constant threat of erasure?”

Inclusion asks, “Has everyone’s ideas been heard?”

Social Justice responds, “Whose ideas won’t be taken as seriously because they aren’t in the majority?”

Inclusion asks, “Is this environment safe for everyone to feel like they belong?”

Social Justice challenges, “Whose safety is being sacrificed and minimized to allow others to be comfortable maintaining stereotypical and dehumanizing views?”

Acknowledging Special Days:

Diversity asks, “Have we celebrated everyone’s days of significance?”

Social Justice challenges, “Whose special days will be given primacy? Who will be tokenized? And who will be erased?”

Activities, Celebrations and Events:

Inclusion asks, “Can everyone participate?”

Social Justice challenges, “What barriers will prevent people from participating? What assumptions are we making?

Diversity celebrates increases in numbers of marginalized groups and incremental growth.

Equity celebrates reductions in harm, revisions to abusive systems and increases in supports for people who have been discriminated against.

Inclusion celebrates awards for initiatives and credits itself for having a diverse group of people.

Social Justice celebrates getting rid of practices and policies that were having disparate impacts on marginalized groups.

Diversity is a FACT

Equity is an ACT

Inclusion does little to address the significant barriers that marginalized people face in even making it into the very spaces that purport inclusive practices.

Social justice is about distributing resources fairly and treating all students equitably so that they feel safe and secure—physically and psychologically.

The pandemic is highlighting for us gross inequities that have existed for a long time…



Equity of Opportunity, Access and Outcomes

The Waterloo Region District School Board is committed to maintaining a learning and working environment which actively promotes and supports human rights, where equity of opportunity, access and outcomes are realized. The Board recognizes the value of:

- each and every student;
- a strong public education system;
- a partnership of students, schools, family and community;
- the uniqueness and diversity of our students and our community;
- the commitment and skills of our staff;
- equity, innovation, accountability and accessibility
- learning and working environments that are safe, nurturing, positive and respectful.

Questions?